Administrator Professional Certification Learning Path

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Welcome

Welcome to the Dynatrace Administration Professional Certification Learning Path.

The Administration Professional Certification focuses on Dynatrace Practitioners who manage the Dynatrace SaaS platform at their organization. This certification allows individuals to show they can maintain their Dynatrace environment(s) to ensure correct access and function for daily Dynatrace users.

Upon completion of this learning path you will be able to:

- Explain how the Dynatrace SaaS platform provisions users and manages permissions
- Apply best practices to configure user provisioning, permissions, and policies
- Manage Dynatrace maintenance and change control processes

- Explain how Dynatrace licensing works and how to report on your organization's consumption
- Recall which Dynatrace components require which standards and configurations
- Explain Dynatrace's data security and privacy protections
- Configure problem notifications and problem management
- Describe how to configure services and process groups
- List the resources to contact for Dynatrace support

Instructions

This learning path is the key to your success in achieving the required skills and knowledge needed for the Administration Professional Certification. We recommend that you follow along in order to best prepare for your certification exam.

Prerequisites

Before embarking on the Dynatrace Administration Professional Learning Path and scheduling the exam, ensure you meet the following prerequisites:

- Six or more months of hands-on experience with the Dynatrace platform.
- Basic understanding of how OneAgent works.
- Basic understanding of DQL.
- Basic understanding of application security concepts.

Learning Path Overview

Before embarking on the Dynatrace Administration Professional Learning Path and scheduling the exam, ensure you meet the following prerequisites:

- **Complete all sections:** Go through every section of the Dynatrace Administration Professional Learning Path meticulously.
- **Review buttons and subtopics:** Ensure all buttons and subtopics within each section are thoroughly reviewed to grasp the nuances of the Dynatrace platform comprehensively.
- **Complete recommended action items:** Pay special attention to the "call to action" section at the end of each lesson and execute the recommended action items to reinforce your learning.
- **Schedule your exam:** Once you feel confident in your understanding of the material and have completed all sections, schedule your exam to become a certified Dynatrace Administration Professional.

Exam Details

Before embarking on the Dynatrace Administration Professional Learning Path and scheduling the exam, ensure you meet the following prerequisites:

- The exam consists of 70 written questions and 10-20 practical questions.
- The written section includes both multiple-choice and multiple-response questions.
- For multiple-response questions, partial percentage for each correct answer is given, and the same percentage is deducted for an incorrect choice.
- Exam proctoring is provided in English only.

- The practical section is open book.

System Requirements

Ensure your system meets the following requirements before attempting the exam:

- Desktop computer or laptop (PC or Mac) connected to a power source.
- Webcam (portable enough to scan the room), computer, or plug-in microphone (headset microphones or headphones are not allowed), and speakers must remain ON throughout the test.
- Chrome browser with pop-up blocker disabled.
- Dual monitors are not allowed.
- Test your readiness with Examity here. Examity will use GoToMeeting for remote proctoring.

Environmental Requirements

Adhere to the following environmental requirements during the exam:

- Maintain a clear desk and workspace, clearing off whiteboards and bulletin boards.
- Remain alone in the room throughout the test; book a conference room or equivalent private space if taking the exam at your workplace.
- Cell phones or tablets are not permitted.

- Do not leave your seat during the exam.
- Communication is restricted to the proctor only.
- In case of disconnection, do not attempt to log back in; contact Examity for assistance.

Identity Confirmation

You will need to confirm your identity with the Examity proctor, including providing your ID and answering security questions set during account creation.

Accommodation

If you require accommodation to access the exam, please create a support ticket to request assistance. Dynatrace is committed to ensuring exam accessibility for all individuals.

Getting Started with Administering the Dynatrace Platform

Dynatrace Platform

The Dynatrace platform is most powerful in delivering answers and insights from your organization's data when it is architected and maintained according to best practices. Whether you are involved in the initial implementation of the Dynatrace platform at your organization or not, following the best practices and considering the elements mentioned in this learning path will set you up for a proactive, well-managed platform that your organization can use for daily insights.

Upon completion, you should be able to:

- Recall the components of administering the Dynatrace platform

Monitoring Platform Health

Monitoring the health of the components of your platform is critical to ensuring stable performance. From OneAgent and ActiveGates to Real User Monitoring and Extensions, elements of Dynatrace should be monitored at scale for their health so anomalies can be resolved with minimal impact. Additionally, you can make use of self-monitoring metrics to streamline and speed up remediation.

Configuration

Correct configuration of your Dynatrace environment, including cloud and Kubernetes installations, drives healthy usage.

User Management & Permissions

To use your data to monitor and troubleshoot issues, your organization's users must be provisioned correctly with the right permissions to access relevant data for their business needs.

Data Privacy and Security

Describe how Dynatrace protects your data, and how to follow standard best practices to ensure the highest level of data privacy and security.

Filters and Segments

Ensure that your organization's teams only see the data necessary for their business needs, limiting unnecessary consumption, speeding up performance, and simplifying their problem-solving workflows.

Maintenance and Upgrades

Dynatrace is always innovating. Learn best practices when it comes to staying aware of maintenance needs and how to plan upgrades.

Licensing

No matter your model, it's important to understand how Dynatrace usage is licensed so you can assist with your organization's questions and choose the best configurations over time.

Support

Learn which resources to use when you or the teams you support have questions about Dynatrace or need help

Call to Action

To help you gain hands on experience in the Dynatrace Platform, it is recommended that you take the following actions.

1. Become familiar with the settings in your Dynatrace environment.

2. Understand how to get to each setting to be able to easily navigate for the following sections of this learning path.

3. Explore and understand our Levels of Data Protection : https://docs.dynatrace.com/docs/manage/data-privacy-and-security/data-privacy/levels-of-data-protection

Monitoring Platform Health

Platform Health

Monitoring the health of your platform's components at scale ensures that you can quickly remediate any anomalies to reduce the impact of any issues.

In this section, we will examine the ways to monitor your Dynatrace platform's components. Upon completion, you should be able to:

- Recall the importance of monitoring your platform components proactively and at scale

- Explain how to monitor the health of your OneAgent, ActiveGates, and Real-User Monitoring
- Describe the extension lifecycle
- Recall how to configure self-monitoring metrics

OneAgent Health

Viewing all your deployed OneAgents at scale and detecting any anomalies helps you prevent problems. In the OneAgent Health overview, you can detect outdated modules that require updates, discover connectivity issues and incompatibilities, restart stopped processes, and identify any OneAgents where auto-updates are disabled.

Read the following documentation to deepen your knowledge of how to monitor the health of your deployed OneAgents, including possible health states of OneAgent modules and recommended remediation.

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ActiveGate Health and Diagnostics

ActiveGates can be used to route OneAgent traffic to Dynatrace, monitor cloud environments, and monitor remote technologies using extensions, in addition to running synthetic monitors or installing modules for z/OS monitoring. As such, they form an important part of your Dynatrace ecosystem and should be monitored regularly for their health.

Fully automated ActiveGate troubleshooting is available. It enables you to pinpoint ActiveGate-related issues and collect diagnostic data and get potential solutions, letting you quickly resolve

issues on your own and reduce time spent diagnosing.

Read this documentation to learn more about ActiveGate purposes and functionality.

VISIT PAGE

Read this documentation to understand how to run this fully automated ActiveGate troubleshooting.

VISIT PAGE

Real-User Monitoring Health

Real-User Monitoring allows you to support the best business outcomes for your organization, so ensuring the health of your RUM Dynatrace components is business-critical.

Running an application health check in Dynatrace allows you to check the most common issues that might affect your web application (along with explanations) and confirm that the RUM JavaScript is injected correctly. This will help you troubleshoot any RUM issues if data is partially or completely missing.

Refer to Dynatrace documentation to learn more about application health checks, RUM statuses, and remediation.

VISIT PAGE

Extension Lifecycle

Dynatrace is an open and extensible platform. You can extend the observability data collected out of the box with data provided by

observability standards and frameworks such as OpenTelemetry and Prometheus.

Learn more about extensions here.

VISIT PAGE

Extensions 2.0 Lifecycle

Your organization may create and manage extensions to centralize and automate these data collection configurations. Therefore, monitoring the health of your extensions is key to ensuring that your data collection is functioning as expected.

There are three ways to manage your extensions:

- Dynatrace Extensions app (in the latest Dynatrace)
- Dynatrace Hub
- Dynatrace API

Refer to this documentation to learn more about adding and configuring extensions, including viewing their status.

VISIT PAGE

Go directly to the Dynatrace Hub to learn more about the Extensions app or install it in your environment.

VISIT PAGE

Self-Monitoring Metrics

While access to health data is helpful, self-monitoring is even better. Dynatrace offers a special self-monitoring category of metrics to provide observability into the operation and health of Dynatrace components and features.

You can use these self-monitoring metrics in multiple ways, including seeing the operation and health of a Dynatrace environment over time, creating dashboards to quickly access self-monitoring data, and get insights into the operation of a specific ActiveGate.

Refer to this documentation to see self-monitoring metrics in action with examples.

VISIT PAGE

Call to Action

To help you gain hands on experience in Monitoring Platform Health, it is recommended that you take the following actions.

1. From a OneAgent or an ActiveGate, try running OneAgent or ActiveGate diagnostics. Understand what artefacts are pulled from this.

2. Within your environment, explore the pages mentioned above, such as OneAgent Health and the Dynatrace Hub.

Platform Configuration

Platform Configuration

Learn how to configure aspects of the platform, to enable team access as well as allow the ingestion of key business data.

After completing this section, you will be able to:

- Define the best practices of user and group management to ensure proper access to Dynatrace
- Recall how to configure ActiveGates

- Explain how to enable and ingest logs for analytics
- Recall how to enable Application Security modules for protection against vulnerabilities
- Define how to monitor your cloud provider(s)
- Recall how to install Kubernetes monitoring to view the health of your container ecosystem

SSO Configuration

Dynatrace SaaS enables authentication through your organization's identity provider (IdP). If you want to use your organization's corporate credentials for authentication in Dynatrace, you can set up SAML to delegate authentication to your IdP.

Read more about configuring SSO via SAML in this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

User and Group Configuration

To ensure your team's access to Dynatrace, you can manage user permissions based on user account membership in user groups. This simplifies the provisioning of permissions.

Users and groups can be managed in three ways:

- Through the Dynatrace-provided user database
- Through LDAP

- Through an IdP (identity provider) with SAML or SCIM protocols

To learn more about managing users and groups, refer to this document.

VISIT PAGE

Refer to this document for additional details on user management.

VISIT PAGE

Refer to this document for additional details on group management.

VISIT PAGE

Refer to this document to understand how to configure authentication via SAML.

VISIT PAGE

Refer to this document to understand how to configure authentication via SCIM.

VISIT PAGE

ActiveGate Configuration

While you may not be involved in the initial implementation of ActiveGates in your Dynatrace environment, understanding their configuration is still important. There are different ways to set up your ActiveGates, and you can customize them based on what you want them to achieve in your environment.

Learn more about the configuration properties and parameters of ActiveGates,

along with proxies, reverse proxies, and load balancers, in this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Log Ingestion

As part of configuring and managing your Dynatrace environment, you may be asked to support the ingestion of logs and other key system data. Logs can be ingested in different ways and from many different sources:

- Via OneAgent
- Via API (including OpenTelemetry Collector, Fluent Bit, FluentD, and Logstash)
- Via Extensions
- Via ActiveGate (syslog)

Refer to this documentation to learn more about the methods of log ingestion, their benefits, and their configuration.

VISIT PAGE

Enabling Application Security

To monitor your stack for potential vulnerabilities, their severity, and potential remediation, you can enable Application Security in your environment. You can use your ingested security data to then review your security posture, conduct threat hunting and forensics, automate CSPM notifications and alerts, respond faster to attacks, and more.

Learn about the many use cases for Application Security in your environment by

reviewing this documentation.

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Learn more about getting started with Application Security in this documentation.

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Specific guidance for activating Application Security can be found here.

VISIT PAGE

Cloud Provider Monitoring

By providing deep integrations with the three major public cloud provider services to capture metrics, metadata, events, logs, and traces, Dynatrace unifies all the data sources and brings them into context to provide end-to-end visibility and Davis AI-powered analysis of this data. With over 600+ integrations, extensions, and technology-specific support, Dynatrace provides extensive monitoring support, including your serverless technologies running on AWS, Azure, or Google Cloud.

To learn more about the challenges of monitoring serverless technologies and how Dynatrace supports their observability, refer to this overview.

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To get started with serverless monitoring:

1. Turn on cloud service monitoring

2. Enable Dynatrace extensions on cloud services

3. Configure advanced visibility

With a single integration per cloud vendor, Dynatrace automatically discovers your cloud services and monitors the services to provide you with out-of-the-box service health and availability monitoring. loud.

Refer to this documentation for specific configuration steps on Amazon CloudWatch Integration.

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Refer to this documentation for specific configuration steps on Azure Monitor Integration.

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Refer to this documentation for specific configuration steps on Google Cloud Operations Suite Integration.

VISIT PAGE

Kubernetes Monitoring

Just as it is important to monitor your serverless technologies and cloud providers, insights into the health of your Kubernetes environment are also important. Once your Kubernetes observability is configured, you can then take steps to remediate issues or design auto-remediation to save time.

Depending on your organization's setup and requirements, Kubernetes monitoring can be deployed in different ways, providing more or less observability to comply with requirements.

Refer to this documentation for an overview of deploying and managing your Kubernetes observability.

VISIT PAGE

Watch this video for more help choosing the right deployment mode for your team.

WATCH VIDEO

Call to Action

To help you gain hands on experience in Platform Configuration, it is recommended that you take the following actions.

1 Explore a demo environment's Kubernetes page.

2 Understand how each Kubernetes object is a unique entity type within Dynatrace. This is important when selecting specific entity types within various configurations in Dynatrace.

3 Explore the settings available a deployed OneAgent and ActiveGate in your environment.

Supporting Data Privacy and Security

Supporting Data Privacy and Security

Privacy laws around the globe are improving the protection of personal data in response to an evolving technology landscape, increased globalization, and complex international data flows. Companies are held accountable for transparency, fairness, and accuracy in how they collect, store, use, and protect personal data.

After completing this section, you will be able to:

- Identify RUM data privacy settings and the user data they enable you to mask
- Explain the purpose of the credential vault

- Define the benefits of log masking
- Contrast the levels of data protection available

Introduction

At Dynatrace, we take our responsibility to safeguard your data seriously. In this section, we will examine how Dynatrace supports your data privacy and security. For a comprehensive overview of resources related to data privacy and security, and how Dynatrace enables you to be in full control of your data, please review this documentation:

Learn about Data privacy and security.

VISIT PAGE

Learn about Data privacy at Dynatrace.

VISIT PAGE

Learn about Dynatrace Trust Center.

VISIT PAGE

RUM Data Privacy Settings

While Real-User Monitoring provides you with key insights to improve your customers' experience, it is important to consider which customer data is necessary to monitor, and to comply with industry regulations and standards around data collection.

Before enabling Session Replay and proceeding with privacy configuration settings, first you should ensure that your organization has taken all other necessary steps to protect your customers' data, as described in this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

You can configure monitoring consumption and data privacy settings for Session Replay, including the following options:

- Opt-in mode to decide which parts of a user session should be recorded and enable your application's users to consent to recording of their sessions
- URL exclusion to exclude pages and views from recording
- Masking to prevent the recording and display of private user information

View this documentation to learn how to configure these data-privacy settings for Session Replay.

VISIT PAGE

Note that the ability to replay recorded user sessions, with or without playback masking settings, is permission-controlled. "Replay sessions with masking" and "Replay sessions without masking" permissions are available at the environment and management-zone level. These permissions ensure that you are only granting access to the individuals and teams who have a business justification for this data.

Credential Vault for Synthetic Monitors

The credential vault is a centralized repository where you securely store and manage credentials (username-password pairs, certificates, or tokens) used by synthetic monitors (browser and HTTP), Extensions 2.0 extensions, and AppEngine apps. The contents of credentials in the vault are not visible to any user, including the creator; they are visible only to the synthetic monitors that reference them.

View this documentation to learn about accessing the credential vault, credential scopes, and creating a credential vault API.

VISIT PAGE

Log Masking

Your logs may contain sensitive data that requires masking before you can use it for analytics, observability, security, and other purposes. Dynatrace provides you with tools that enable you to meet your data protection and other compliance requirements while still getting value from your logs.

Choose one or both methods, based on your information architecture and log setup:

- Masking at capture: This approach allows masking sensitive data in your environment, hosts or processes before it is transferred to the Dynatrace SaaS environment, using OneAgent.
- Masking at ingest: This approach allows masking sensitive data once it arrives in the Dynatrace SaaS environment, and before it is written to disk (stored).

We recommend that you combine masking data at capture with masking data at ingest, to set up two layers of security.

Review this documentation to learn more about the methods of masking sensitive data.

VISIT PAGE

To learn more about masking logs at capture via OneAgent, review this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

To learn more about masking logs at ingest by creating log processing rules, review this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Levels of Data Protection

Depending on your environment setup and settings, you might capture data for which you have legal obligations due to protection laws, standards, and regulations, such as GDPR, CCPA, HIPAA, LGPD, PCI-DSS and more. To address such cases, Dynatrace offers multiple layers of protection to help you fine-tune the data flows in Dynatrace:

- Masking at capture
- Masking at storage
- Masking at display

View this documentation to learn more about how Dynatrace enables you to

protect personal data at various points in your data flow.

VISIT PAGE

Call to Action

To help you gain hands on experience in Supporting Data Privacy and Security, it is recommended that you take the following actions.

1. Explore the log masking settings within your environment at Settings > Log Monitoring > Sensitive data masking.

2. Within a monitored application in your environment, explore the General Settings -> Data Privacy -> Session Replay settings for masking to understand the different options for masking.

Configuration Tasks

Configuration Tasks

Explore how settings and configuration work in Dynatrace, and understand how these connect during your administration of the platform. Examine which layers of your environment you can apply settings to.

After completing this section, you will be able to:

- Explain how settings at different scopes are honored by Dynatrace
- Recall how to access configuration revision history to audit your environment
- Define the purpose of the Settings API

Settings Scope

Many settings can be set for different scopes (for an entire monitoring environment or a specific entity). The default scope is global (the entire monitoring environment).

Configurations that are available via Settings (in Dynatrace, go to Settings) affect the entire environment. You can check for existing entity-level overrides of the environment-level setting. Select More (...) > Hierarchy and overrides. From here, you can easily navigate to entity-level configurations, which in turn provide information on the parent setting.

The most specific setting always takes precedence. For example, a configuration on the host level overrides a configuration on the host-group level, and in turn, a host-group level configuration overrides an environment-level configuration.

If a setting is available at multiple levels, manage it on the highest possible level. High-level settings scale automatically to every child entity; you don't have to apply them manually.

Read this documentation to learn more about the scope of settings and when order matters.

VISIT PAGE

Configuration Revision History

Every Settings 2.0 configuration maintains a history of changes, keeping track of changes to the configuration and who made these changes. This insight is critical for auditing purposes.

To learn how to access configuration history, read this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

DQL Queries for Admins

If you need to review system events to determine what caused a scenario such as data deletion or excess licensing consumption, you can use Dynatrace Query Language for this.

To learn more about beneficial DQL queries to help you manage your environment, read this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Config / Settings API

The Settings 2.0 framework provides a unified instrument to control various configurations in Dynatrace. Whether you use the Dynatrace web UI or the Settings API, you're setting the same configurations with the same effect.

To learn more about setting schemas, view schema parameters, or creating, editing, or deleting settings objects, view this documentation about the Settings API.

VISIT PAGE

To learn more about to manage settings, view this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Call to Action

To help you gain hands on experience how Settings and Configuration work in Dynatrace, it is recommended that you take the following actions.

1. Explore different Settings 2.0 concepts within your environment following this documentation: https://docs.dynatrace.com/docs/manage/settings-20

2. Review the DQL Queries for Admins above and try some of the examples given there in your environment.

Centralized Settings

Centralized Settings

While many aspects of Dynatrace allow you fine-grained control of how you monitor, other settings—called centralized settings—impact every monitored component in your environment. For example, every component in your stack will be part of a network zone, a tag, a maintenance window, or a host group. Beyond these centralized settings, you can later filter into individual components to adjust settings if needed.

After completing this section, you will be able to:

- Define the features of the OneAgent

- Explain how to install or migrate a network zone
- Recall the steps to set up a management zone
- Compare and contrast between tags and metadata
- Explain the purpose of setting up a maintenance window
- Recall how to configure anomaly detection
- Explain how to organize your environment with host groups
- Recall how ownership helps you organize your environment

OneAgent Features

When you create your environment, OneAgent comes with a big set of features that are activated by default. Nevertheless, you always need to explicitly activate features added by newer versions of OneAgent and opt-in features, such as the automatic enrichment of log entries with the trace ID. .

To learn about the scope and use cases for OneAgent features, read this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Network Zones

Network zones are Dynatrace entities that represent your network structure. They help you to route traffic efficiently, avoiding unnecessary traffic across data centers and network regions.

Deployment of network zones depends on whether you're starting a new Dynatrace deployment (new installation scenario) or adding network zones to an existing deployment (migration scenario). In either case, however, the overall steps are the same.

To learn about migrating or installing network zones and connectivity for OneAgents and ActiveGates, read this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Management Zones

If your Dynatrace environment uses Management Zones for segmenting data or limiting access to data, as an administrator it's important to understand how Management Zones and tagging work in Dynatrace.

Management zones are a powerful information-partitioning mechanism that promotes focus on specific parts of your observed topology and the sharing of relevant team-specific data while simultaneously ensuring access control.

Management zones may overlap, just as team responsibilities might overlap. Users may be granted access to entire environments, a specific management zone, or a subset of related management zones. Dynatrace users see auto-filtered views of their environment based on the management zones that they can access. Users who have access to multiple management zones can focus on any management zone and filter all Dynatrace views so that they only see the metrics that are related to the entities of that management zone.

To learn about setting up Management Zones, their rules, and how to apply and use Management Zones, refer to this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Tagging

Dynatrace OneAgent automatically discovers components in your environment, such as process groups, services and real user applications. Not only can these entities be auto-discovered, their underlying technologies can also be accurately identified (for example, Apache HTTP server, IBM WebSphere, and much more). As part of this auto-detection, Dynatrace discovers network topology as well. Once traffic is monitored, Dynatrace detects also load balancers and proxies. Moreover, Dynatrace supports 3rd party integrations, thus augmenting this data with topology and monitoring information from AWS, VMware, Azure, OpenStack, and more.

Managing such a huge amount of information, however, and organizing such large monitoring environments is a real challenge. To effectively cope with this challenge, Dynatrace supports tags and metadata. Like management zones, tags and metadata enable you to organize your monitored environments in a meaningful way. Tags in Dynatrace are basically labels or markers while metadata are key/value pairs that are inherent to any monitored entity. Metadata are mainly used for defining extra information for entities while tags are used for organizing entities. You can also create tags based on metadata. In general, although tags and metadata are closely related, they are different concepts and are created and used in a different way.

View this documentation to understand how tagging works in Dynatrace.

VISIT PAGE

View this documentation to understand about best practices for tagging.

VISIT PAGE

Automatic tag and management zone assignment helps keep your monitoring environment organized and directs the focus of individual teams to the infrastructure they're responsible for. To learn more about best practices for tagging and management zone rules, read more here.

VISIT PAGE

Defining Maintenance Windows

Your organization might have some planned or ad hoc periods of time during which your system undergoes maintenance activities that can cause service disruption. During such periods, you might not want to receive notifications that your services are down. Additionally, such periods shouldn't be taken into account when monitoring the availability of your system. To avoid such situations, you can exclude these periods by defining maintenance windows.

Maintenance windows enable Dynatrace to identify periods of possibly abnormal operation such as downtimes, reduced performance periods, and high-traffic events during load tests. Defining maintenance windows during times of abnormal operation helps you reduce alert spam and keep your baselines clean for accurate monitoring and alerting.

In general, it's good practice to keep your performance monitoring system informed of scheduled maintenance to ensure accurate monitoring data. Dynatrace enables you to define maintenance windows using either the Configuration API or the Dynatrace web UI.

Dynatrace also distinguishes between two types of maintenance windows: planned and unplanned.

To learn more about how maintenance windows work, view this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Learn how to define maintenance windows via configuration API or the Dynatrace web UI in this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Anomaly Detection

Dynatrace continuously monitors the performance of every aspect of your applications, services, and infrastructure to automatically learn all baseline metrics and the overall health of each component in your environment, including the response times of your applications and services.

Variables such as geolocation, browser type, operating system, connection bandwidth, and user actions are factored in automatically. This intelligent automated baselining allows Dynatrace to detect anomalies at a highly granular level and to notify you of detected problems in real time. You can customize the thresholds generated through automated baselining either by adapting the sensitivity of problem detection or, if necessary, by defining your own static thresholds.

Read an overview of anomaly detection and Davis AI in this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

An anomaly detection configuration relies on several components:

- Data source: a time series that is evaluated. It can be a DQL query, fetching data from Grail or a specific metric.
- Analyzer type and parameters: how the data is evaluated.
- Sliding window: a period over which the data is evaluated.
- Event template: what kind of template is triggered by the configuration.

Once configured and activated, the configuration observes the data and triggers and event when conditions are met. To ensure the configuration works as expected and alerts you about the

right events, you can preview the results of its work either in Davis for Notebooks (the latest Dynatrace) or as a preview for a metric event.

Read more about configuring anomaly detection in this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Learn more about the Anomaly Detector app and how it helps you manage your anomaly detection configurations in the documentation below. Note that configurations in the app will not carry over to your classic Dynatrace platform, and vice versa; they are separate streams.

VISIT PAGE

Host Groups

To help you organize your environment, host groups enable you to categorize and manage multiple hosts that share similar characteristics or purposes within your environment.

Host groups are sets of hosts. Each group can be configured on the host-group level. This makes it easy to change the settings for a large number of hosts. You can define alerting thresholds and OneAgent update settings on a per-host-group basis.

Read more about how host groups affect and organize your monitoring environment in this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

To help you manage your host groups, Dynatrace allows you to check host group assignments, list all hosts in a host group, and assign a host to a host group (during

or after OneAgent installation). Learn more about using host groups in this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Ownership of Monitored Entities

Assigning team owners to monitored entities in Dynatrace drives effective DevSecOps collaboration across your organization and swift, smart resolution of incidents and service degradations.

Ownership metadata attached to entities feeds your BizDevSecOps workflows, ensuring that the right people from among your security, operations, infrastructure, line of business, and development teams are brought together with the right information in context.

Knowledge about the ownership of an entity enables additional automation, such as:

- Notification of relevant teams of production issues that need their attention.
- Creation of IT service management tickets (for example, in Jira and ServiceNow) and assignment to the right teams.
- Assignment of vulnerabilities to the responsible team members.
- Provision of information to all relevant stakeholders.

Read this documentation to learn about the concept of ownership in Dynatrace.

VISIT PAGE

To learn more about how ownership can function in your organization, refer to these use cases and examples.

VISIT PAGE

Be sure to follow best practices, as defined here, for entity ownership to scale ownership effectively and minimize time taken for tagging runs.

VISIT PAGE

Call to Action

To help you gain hands on experience on Centralized Settings, it is recommended that you take the following actions.

1. Explore the Ownership feature within your settings to be able to add Ownership of a team to entities in your environment.

2

Explore each of the above features within your environment and be able to create or alter Host Groups, Network Zones, Management Zones, Maintenance Windows, and Tags.

Production Notifications, Upgrades, and Maintenance

Production Notifications, Upgrades, and Maintenance

From problems detected by Dynatrace in your environment, you can receive notifications through various integrations or via the Dynatrace mobile app and gain quick insights into the problem. You can also set up alert-filtering rules that are based on the severity, customer impact, associated tags, and/or duration of detected problems. Lastly, you can define maintenance windows during which alerts won't be generated.

In this section we will examine various options for notifications, alerts, and integrations.

Problem Notifications

Dynatrace provides full-stack monitoring insights into your complete IT operation and automatically detects if any part of your deployment doesn't fulfill the required quality in terms of performance or error rates. Whenever Dynatrace detects such abnormal system behavior, it creates a single problem that contains all incidents that share the same root cause.

Dynatrace enables you to automatically push problem notifications to your preferred third-party incident management or ChatOps service. Open problems are continuously updated based on evolving impact and correlating events. To avoid notification spam, problem notifications are only pushed to third-party systems when problems are initially detected and when they are ultimately resolved.

To understand how Dynatrace lets you push problem notifications to other services, read this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Example notification to integrate with ServiceNow

You may wish to integrate your Dynatrace monitoring environment to your ServiceNow instance, in order to provide automatic creation and updating of problems in both systems.

To connect these instances, configuration is required both on the ServiceNow instance and in the Dynatrace web UI.

Read more about incident integration with ServiceNow in this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Alerting profile vs. Integration

Problem alerting profiles control the delivery of problem notifications across your organization's alerting channels. Problem alerting profiles allow you to control exactly which conditions result in problem notifications and which don't. Problem alerting profiles can also be used to set up filtered problem-notification integrations with third-party messaging systems like Slack, Opsgenie, and PagerDuty.

Alerting profiles provide a powerful filtering mechanism for problem notifications. By combining filter criteria, you can create custom profiles that, for example, delay notification of problems in development environments while immediately alerting on problems detected in production environments.

View more about creating alerting profiles in this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Setting Maintenance Windows

Recall that, earlier in this learning, we discussed the purpose of maintenance windows: to avoid receiving notifications about services that are down during planned maintenance.

As a refresher, review this documentation about how to set maintenance windows.

VISIT PAGE

Workflows for notification purposes

To improve incident triage and speed up resolution, you may wish to set up automated workflows that use your observability and security data to:

- Inform stakeholders through communication tools
- Open incident tickets
- Trigger configuration management tools
- Remediate directly by executing Kubernetes jobs or creating pull requests

In these situations and many more, you can use Workflows to automate responses with your integrated systems based on your specific criteria.

Learn more about available integrations and building automated Workflows with them in this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

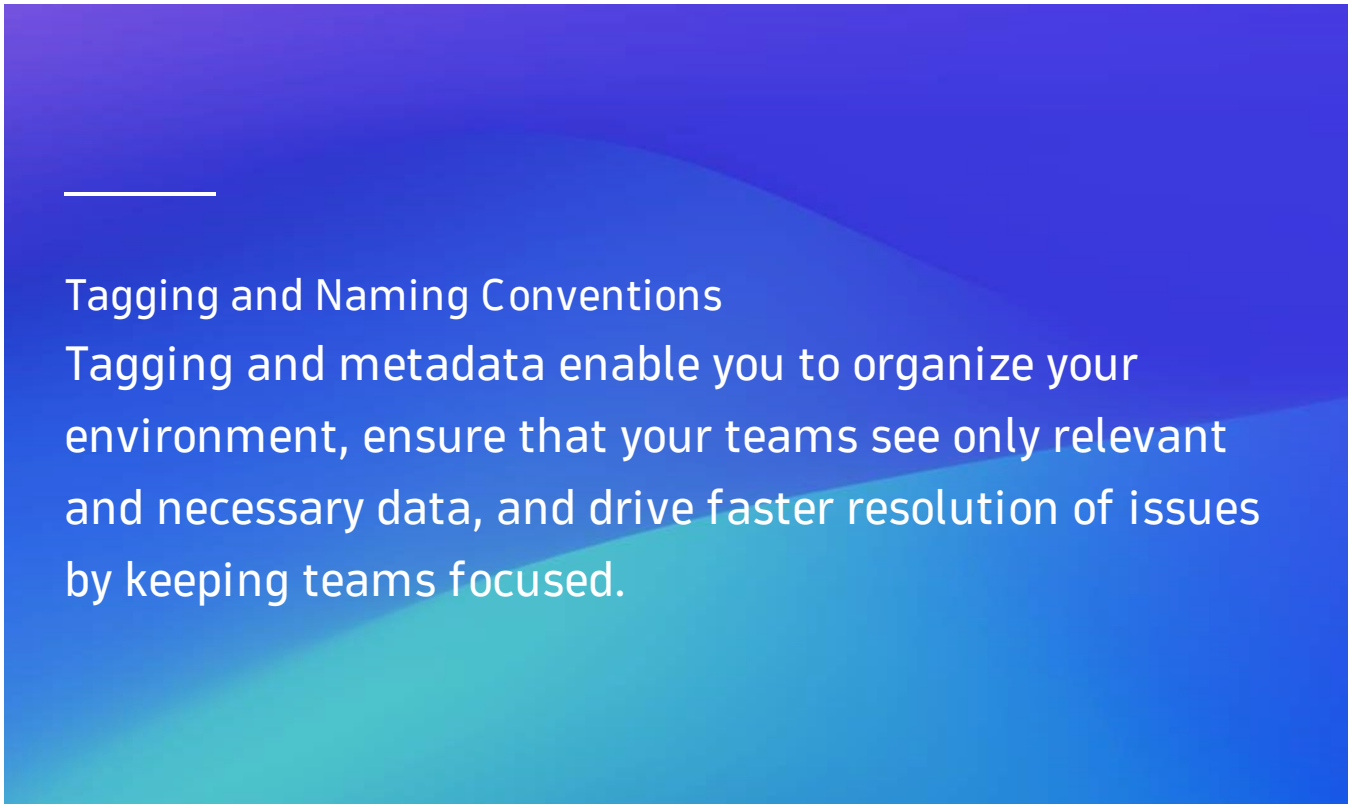
Call to Action

To help you gain hands on experience on product notifications, alerts, and integrations, it is recommended that you take the following actions.

1. Explore some of the above example workflows for notification purposes, such as sending an email notification through a workflow: https://docs.dynatrace.com/docs/analyze-explore-automate/workflows/actions/email

2. Understand how an Alerting Profile relates to a Problem Notification Integration. Try setting up a Problem Notification.

Tagging and Naming Conventions



After completing this section, you will be able to:

- Explain the purpose of tagging in your environment
- Compare and contrast between tagging and metadata
- Explain how properties populate metadata
- Compare and contrast between built-in and custom service naming rules

- List the steps to define process group naming rules

Tagging

As you will recall from earlier in this learning, tags and metadata both enable you to organize your monitored environments in a meaningful way.

Tags in Dynatrace are labels or markers, while metadata are key/value pairs that are inherent to any monitored entity. Metadata are mainly used for defining extra information for entities, while tags are used for organizing entities. You can also create tags based on metadata. In general, although tags and metadata are closely related, they are different concepts and are created and used in a different way.

Review this documentation to understand how tagging works in Dynatrace.

VISIT PAGE

Review this documentation about best practices for tagging.

VISIT PAGE

Review this documentation about best practices for scaling tagging and management-zone rules.

VISIT PAGE

Tagging versus metadata

Dynatrace differentiates between tags and metadata. Metadata properties are key/value pairs that are inherent to any monitored entity. Tags in Dynatrace are labels or markers that do not belong to an entity.

To learn more about the difference between tags and metadata, refer to this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Properties and metadata

To automate the organization of your environment, Dynatrace automatically detects and displays lots of metadata values related to the processes that run in your environment. Dynatrace then enables you to use these metadata values to automate tagging, as well as to use environment variables to supply tags. As an example, Dynatrace supports automated tagging in Kubernetes based on Kubernetes labels or Kubernetes annotations.

Dynatrace even allows you to define your own metadata based on your organization's or environment's unique needs.

To learn more about using properties and metadata for process groups, review this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Service naming rules

For further automated assistance, Dynatrace automatically detects and names your applications' server-side services based on basic properties of your application deployment and configuration. Built-in rules define these names. These properties and the resulting service names should be intuitive to you because they reflect your service landscape. Still, you might

want to customize these names. Custom service naming rules enable you to enhance automated service naming.

Review the built-in and custom service naming rules for Dynatrace in this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Process and process group naming rules

Not only does Dynatrace automatically detect process groups, it also attempts to name them with intuitive names that make sense to your staff who are tasked with deploying and monitoring them. In many cases, however, the auto-generated names created by Dynatrace may either be too generic or not reflect your naming standards. To change the naming schemes of detected process groups, you need process group naming rules.

The steps to define or enrich naming rules are listed in this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Call to Action

To help you gain hands on experience on tagging and naming conventions, it is recommended that you take the following actions.

1. Try creating a process group naming rule, following the process group naming documentation: https://docs.dynatrace.com/docs/observe/infrastructure-monitoring/process-groups/configuration/pg-naming

2. Within your environment, explore the Service naming rules. Try creating a custom naming rule based on a service within your environment, using this documentation as a guide: https://docs.dynatrace.com/docs/observe/applications-and-microservices/services/service-detection-and-naming/customize-service-naming

3. Within a tagging rule, try configuring a tag that utilizes the entity selector. Be able to utilize the entity selector in various ways, such as selecting all Hosts with a specific tag. This documentation will help as a guide: https://docs.dynatrace.com/docs/discover-dynatrace/references/dynatrace-api/environment-api/entity-v2/entity-selector

Service-Level Objectives

Service-Level Objectives

In your organization, you may have or wish to define SLOs: service-level objectives. SLOs combine multiple metrics and indicators to closely monitor the reliable delivery of your service against an operational goal.

After completing this section you will be able to:

- Define a service-level objective (SLO)
- Explain how to configure an SLO in Dynatrace

What is a Service-Level Objective (SLO)?

A platform engineering team is responsible for finding good service-level indicators (SLIs) for a given service in order to closely monitor the reliable delivery of that service. SLIs can differ from one service to the other, as not all services are equally critical in terms of time and error constraints.

Once the SRE team has selected a collection of indicator metrics, what remains is to define and monitor the operational goal within a service-level objective (SLO).

A typical SLO consists of the following fundamental data:

- Service-Level Indicator (SLI): The indicator used to measure the successful service delivery.
- Target: The target defines the planned goal to achieve in terms of service delivery.
- Evaluation period: The evaluation period is necessary to standardize communication concerning the SLO result.

To learn more about the basics of SLOs, review this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Configuring and Monitoring SLOs in Dynatrace

To configure a new service-level objective, you can either use the SLO wizard to select from a set of Dynatrace preconfigured templates for common use cases, or you can create your own SLO definitions.

The steps for using the wizard or creating your own SLO definitions are described in this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Call to Action

To help you gain hands on experience on service-level objectives, it is recommended that you take the following actions.

1. Within your environment, try creating an SLO. This may be done using the SLO Wizard example SLOs. Within this SLO, try selecting entities in different ways, such as by tag and by entity type.

Configuring and Maintaining Real-User Monitoring and Synthetic Monitoring

After completing this section you will be able to:

- Explain the purpose of synthetic minimum and maximum frequencies
- Define application detection rules
- Recall how synthetic outages are handled

- Explain how to set synthetic performance thresholds

Introduction

Digital Experience Monitoring consists of two parts:

- Real User Monitoring (RUM)
- Synthetic Monitoring

Both of these types of monitoring are essential to understanding your customers' and users' experience, remediating issues, and proactively preventing future issues from occurring.

Real User Monitoring (RUM) gives you the power to know your customers by providing performance analysis in real time. This includes all user actions taken and how the various actions impact performance. You can also gain insight into the behavior of your users.

Read more about the concept of Real User Monitoring here.

VISIT PAGE

Dynatrace Synthetic Monitoring completes your picture by making it easy for you to monitor the availability and performance of your applications as experienced by your customers around the world and around the clock.

Review more about the concept of Synthetic Monitoring here.

VISIT PAGE

Dynatrace Synthetic Monitoring completes your picture by making it easy for you to monitor the availability and performance of your applications as experienced by your customers around the world and around the clock.

Browser monitors

To assist with Synthetic Monitoring, Dynatrace offers the following types of synthetic monitors: single-URL browser monitors, browser clickpaths, HTTP monitors and NAM monitors.

A single-URL browser monitor is the equivalent of a simulated user visiting your application using a modern, updated web browser. Browser monitors can be configured to run from any of our global public or private locations at frequencies of up to every five minutes. Browser monitors alert you when your application becomes inaccessible or when baseline performance degrades significantly.

To learn more about the basics of single-user browser monitors, read this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

To learn more about configuring browser monitors, visit this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Synthetic monitoring frequency

One important aspect of browser monitors is your monitoring schedule, which consists of:

- How frequently your browser monitor runs

- The number of locations it's executed from

To learn more about your options for out-of-the-box public Synthetic Monitoring Locations and configuring frequency of monitor executions, read this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Application detection rules

With application detection rules, you can define the transactions that can compromise your RUM applications. User actions detected by Dynatrace are grouped together to represent your application from the user perspective, thereby enabling standalone monitoring and analysis in Dynatrace.

For more information about checking that your defined detection rules are detecting traffic from the correct URLs and accurately reflecting the applications they're designed to detect, read this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Synthetic outage handling

Outage handling settings determine what to do in the event of monitor failures (availability outages). Default outage handling behavior can be defined at the environment level for all browser monitors or all HTTP monitors.

Read this documentation to learn more about configuring outage handling, including when to disable problem generation.

VISIT PAGE

Synthetic performance thresholds

To make sense of your monitoring data, you can enable performance thresholds and enter a threshold in seconds for the monitor as a whole and each action. This can, for example, enable you to track performance time (such as when you need to meet SLAs).

To learn more about enabling performance thresholds for synthetic monitoring, read this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

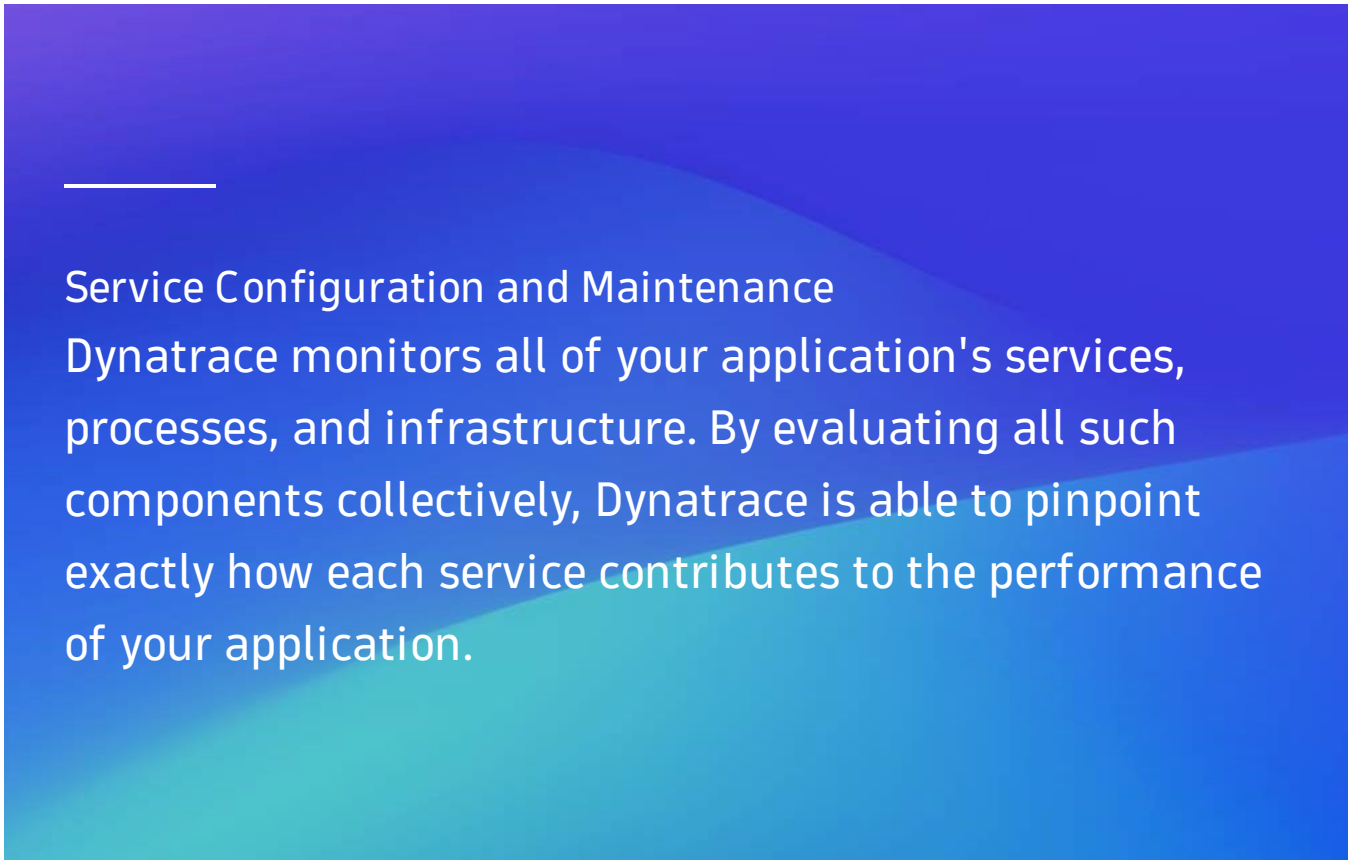
Call to Action

To help you gain hands on experience on configuring and maintaining RUM and Synthetic Monitoring, it is recommended that you take the following actions.

1. Deploy demo application (easyTravel or easyTrade), see it pop up in My Web Application, and then create an application detection rule for it.

2. Try creating an HTTP synthetic monitor and then try creating a Browser Clickpath synthetic monitor. A sample site you can use could be https://www.dynatrace.com/

Service Configuration and Maintenance



After completing this section you will be able to:

- Define custom services
- Recall how to configure request Attributes & OTel attributes

- Explain the purpose of Deep Monitoring

Introduction

You may want to go beyond standard or out-of-the-box detection with custom service definitions or attributes, which are described in this section.

Learn more about Dynatrace services.

VISIT PAGE

Custom Service rules

If your application services aren't built on standard technologies, they may not be recognized out-of-the box. You can monitor these technologies, but you'll need to define them as custom services with specific service entry points.

Another use case for custom services are microservices that are used by a larger application that aren't exposed via communication technologies.

Dynatrace allows you to define any method, class, or interface as the entry point of a service to be monitored.

A custom service is a service that has a manually defined method, class, or interface as its entry point.

To learn more about defining custom services, read this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Request Attributes & OTel attributes

Dynatrace tracks all requests, from end to end, and automatically monitors the services that underlie each transaction. The performance and attributes of each request can be analyzed in detail. You're not limited to just certain predefined attributes. You can also configure custom request attributes that you can use to improve filtering and analysis of web requests.

Read this documentation to learn more about capturing and configuring request attributes.

VISIT PAGE

Deep Monitoring settings

Dynatrace OneAgent is supported on many platforms and offers deep monitoring for many technologies and frameworks. Deep monitoring provides you with further visibility into your services, such as providing further information in your traces if OneAgent features are enabled.

To learn more about service monitoring settings, read this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Process Group Configuration and Maintenance

Process Group Configuration and Maintenance

Dynatrace automatically merges related processes into process groups. A “process group” is a logical cluster of processes that belong to the same application or deployment unit and perform the same function across multiple hosts.

After completing this section you will be able to:

- Explain process group detection rules
- Define declarative processes

- Recall how to monitor process availability

Introduction

Process groups are key building blocks of most modern web-based applications. As part of your business, you will want to monitor the health of your processes and process groups, including metrics, vulnerabilities, and availability.

Learn more about Process Groups.

VISIT PAGE

Process group detection rules

To simplify and organize your data, Dynatrace detects which processes are part of the same process groups by means of a default set of detection rules.

Read more about simple and advanced detection rules in this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Declarative processes

Within large, dynamic environments, the number of processes running on your hosts can become overwhelming. For this reason, Dynatrace automatically monitors important process group types—process groups that are either of a known technology or that consume significant resources.

However, Dynatrace also provides the option of monitoring specific processes that fall into neither of these two categories. This means that you can monitor processes of a technology type unknown to Dynatrace that don't consume significant resources.

To create such a process group, use the declarative process-grouping feature, which enables you to add fine-grained rules to match any specific process group.

Read about how to configure declarative process grouping in this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Process availability

To monitor the availability of key processes on your hosts, you will need to define monitoring rules. After you create a rule, when a matching process is missing on a host, Dynatrace issues an alerting event.

To learn more about rule scope, defining rules, and managing those rules, read this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Extension Governance

Extension Governance

Earlier in this learning we discussed that your organization can extend your observability data with extensions. Monitoring the health and lifecycle of these extensions is a key part of maintaining your Dynatrace environment and proactively mitigating any anomalies.

After completing this section you will be able to:

- Recall the three ways to manage your custom extensions
- Define the purpose of an ActiveGate group

Administering Custom Extensions

As mentioned earlier in this learning, there are three ways to manage your extensions:

- Dynatrace Extensions app (in the latest Dynatrace)
- Dynatrace Hub
- Dynatrace API

Review this documentation to learn more about managing extensions.

VISIT PAGE

ActiveGate Groups

To help you with managing your extensions, you can use ActiveGate groups to perform bulk actions on your ActiveGates, such as managing Extensions 2.0 running on ActiveGates.

An ActiveGate running a remote extension needs to belong to an ActiveGate group because Dynatrace uses a group to instruct the extension where it should run. If you plan to use a single ActiveGate to run a remote extension, assign it to a dedicated group containing only that ActiveGate.

To learn more about ActiveGate groups and activating extensions, read this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

User Management and Access

User Management and Access

Managing the Dynatrace access of your organization's users does not have to be complicated. Dynatrace's modern Identity and Access Management approach provides you with control and flexibility to manage dynamic user groups and assign policies to grant permissions to those groups. Dynatrace also allows you to configure buckets for data storage that enables different retention times as well as controls access to specific data.

After completing this section you will be able to:

- Define how users get added to groups
- Explain how to configure a policy to grant permissions to users or groups
- Recall the purpose of buckets for data storage

Groups

In Dynatrace, user permissions are managed via group membership: users inherit the Dynatrace access permissions that are assigned to the Dynatrace groups they belong to.

Read this documentation to learn about group types, how to create and delete groups, manage group permissions, and automate group assignment via API.

VISIT PAGE

Permissions and Policies

To ensure that users or groups only have access to necessary aspects of Dynatrace and no more, you can configure and assign permissions to them.

Learn about concepts of permissions and policies.

WATCH VIDEO

Learn about best practices in configuring permissions and policies.

WATCH VIDEO

Read this documentation to learn more about configuring and assigning permissions and policies to your users.

VISIT PAGE

Buckets

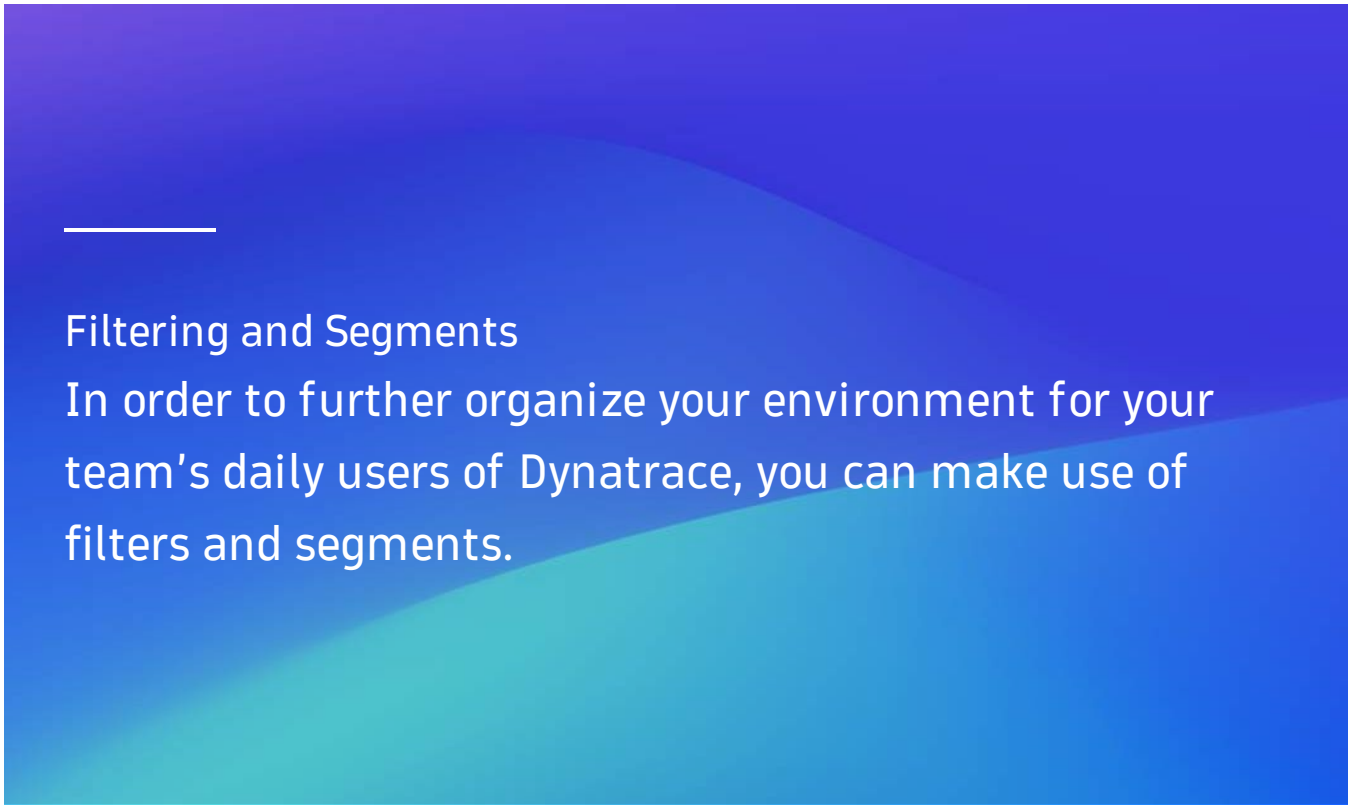
Permissions can be assigned on the bucket, table, and entity levels. Without permissions, your users can't fetch any data from a bucket or table.

You can use built-in buckets and also define your own custom buckets, such as for specific retention periods. This can help improve query performance during data analysis by reducing query execution time and the scope of data read. Additionally, having your data stored in a bucket streamlines your permission management because you can easily provide a user group or single users with access to needed data.

Read this documentation to learn more about assigning permissions to specific buckets.

VISIT PAGE

Filtering and Segments



After completing this section you will be able to:

- Explain the purpose of the entity selector
- Recall the syntax of the entity selector

Monitoring Entities API and Entity Selector

The entity selector is a powerful instrument for specifying which entities you want to include to the scope of your Environment v2 API calls. You can use the entity selector to filter for such fields as tag, OS version, type – any value of the property. It is used in many parts of Dynatrace, such as fetching metrics, tagging resources, assigning resources to a management zone, or utilizing the Dynatrace API.

The entity selector is used in several APIs, so you only need to learn the syntax once and then reuse it for multiple use cases.

To learn more about configuring the Entity Selector, read this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Licensing and Consumption

Licensing and Consumption

Dynatrace offers different licensing models to organizations to best suit their needs and budget their resources for critical business tools. No matter which model your organization employs, tracking and forecasting your licensing consumption is recommended for every Dynatrace administrator.

After completing this section you will be able to:

- Recall what aspects of billing management the Account Management Portal shows you
- Define how to set license limits and what happens if they are exceeded
- Explain how to set DDU limits

- Define cost monitors
- Explain the purpose of the budgets feature

How to access and use Account Management

Dynatrace Account Management provides a single place to:

- Manage Dynatrace license and subscriptions
- Manage Dynatrace users and SSO access (for SaaS deployments only)
- Monitor Dynatrace platform adoption and environment health

Account Management provides you with a real-time view of licensed product consumption (Total license usage), with historical analysis at the daily or hourly level (Usage details).

Watch this video to learn more about the purpose of the Account Management portal.

WATCH VIDEO

Read more about how to access Account Management in this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

To learn more about managing your subscription and licensing in Account Management, read this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

What happens when license limits are breached

When the configured limit for concurrent host units for an environment is reached–assuming that the account is not entitled to use overages—Dynatrace begins enforcing the available limit.

To learn more about how Dynatrace decides which hosts to continue or stop monitoring in this situation, read this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Davis Data Unit (DDU) Pools and Limits

To limit or prevent overages, with DDU (Davis data unit) pools you can define monthly or yearly limits for DDU consumption on a per-environment basis. By default, pool limits are not enforced.

To learn more about configuring DDU limits and review frequently asked questions, read this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Cost Monitors

Cost monitors help you manage your Dynatrace Platform Subscription budget and identify unexpected cost increases. They monitor your overall forecasted usage and warn you when costs increase significantly, or forecasts exceed user-defined threshold amounts. They also monitor daily costs at the capability and environment levels, alerting you when costs exceed predicted levels.

To learn more about the concept of cost monitors, read this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Read more about how to use cost monitors to manage costs.

VISIT PAGE

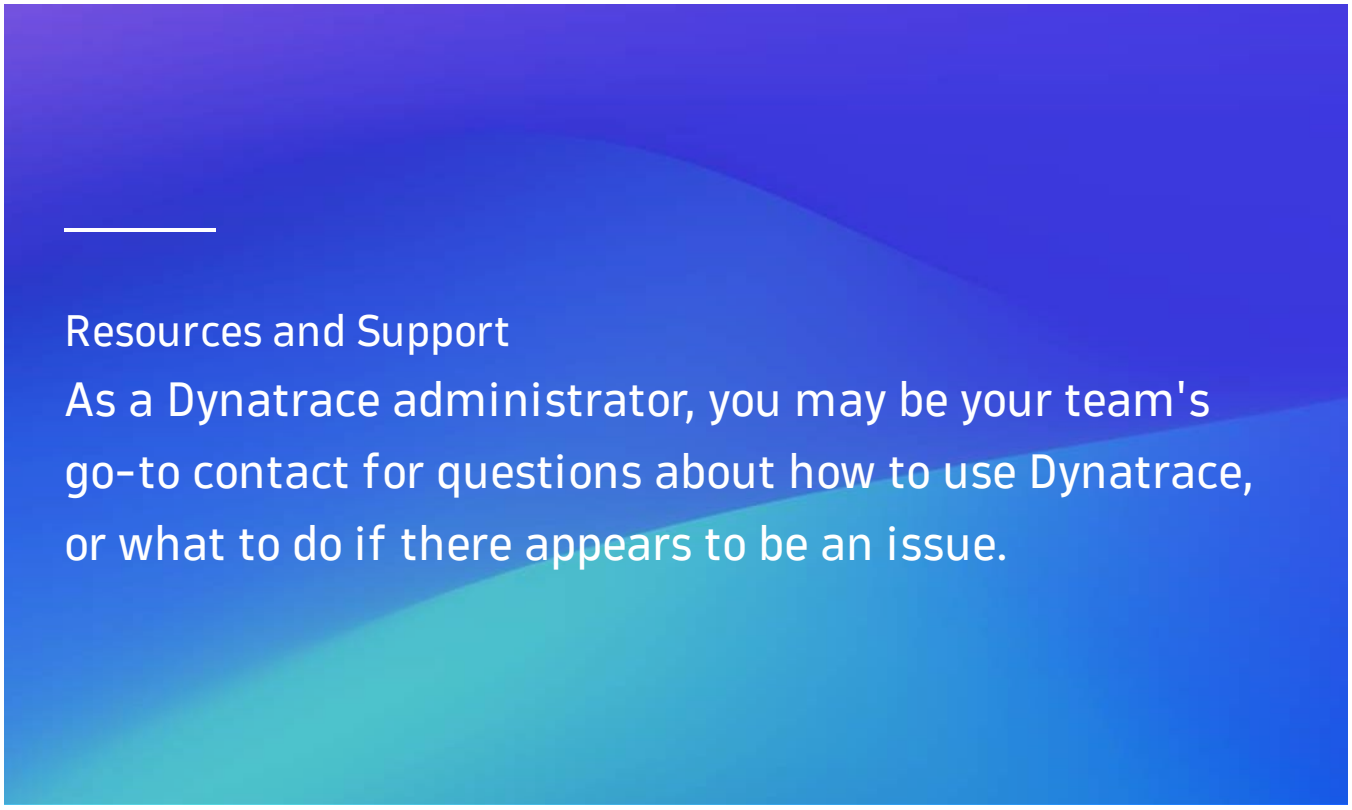
Budgets

The Budgets feature tracks and notifies you when Dynatrace Platform Subscription costs hit a user-defined threshold. You can use Budgets at the account, environment, and capability level and configure notifications to email you when budgets are exceeded. Budgets complement the existing Cost Monitor feature by allowing you to define custom thresholds at the environment and capability level.

To learn more about how to set thresholds with Budgets, read this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Resources and Support



After completing this section you will be able to:

- Compare and contrast between the resources for further learning about Dynatrace
- Recall the support options available

Introduction

In this section we will review the many resources available to check for help, and how to contact Dynatrace support in the event of a question or issue, with many quick links available in the Dynatrace Support Center.

Visit the Dynatrace Support Center

VISIT PAGE

Resources

Many resources are available to assist you and your team in learning about Dynatrace and resolving questions. These resources support a variety of learning styles and organizational preferences.

Dynatrace Documentation – detailed information about aspects of Dynatrace to get started, explore, extend, or troubleshoot.

VISIT PAGE

Release Notes – stay up to date on the latest releases and enhancements.

VISIT PAGE

Dynatrace University – learn and excel with on-demand courses, live training, and certifications like this one.

VISIT PAGE

Enrichment Sessions – demos on specific Dynatrace topics to join live, ask

questions of experts.

VISIT PAGE

Enrichment Sessions – watch on-demand.

VISIT PAGE

Virtual Labs – hands-on instructor-led sessions to build skills and speed up getting value out of your data in Dynatrace.

VISIT PAGE

Dynatrace Community – get the latest tips and tricks from experts and other customers.

VISIT PAGE

Questions and Support

If you have questions not answered in the resources listed above, or have an issue that you need to ask Dynatrace about, you can reach out via live chat. If you are a Dynatrace customer, you can chat directly with our product experts through live chat. Simply sign in to your account and start a new conversation.

- In the latest Dynatrace, select Live chat in the Support resources menu.

Read about how to configure declarative process grouping in this documentation.

VISIT PAGE

Contacting Support

To open a new support ticket or view your existing tickets, visit the Support Portal.

VISIT PAGE